

Changes I've noticed

Write it down when you notice it. Read it back before you act.

One line per thing, dated, in plain words. "Third time the stove was left on." "Didn't come to the phone all Tuesday." The date matters more than it seems: it is how a feeling becomes a timeline.

Date _____ What I noticed _____

Still true a month later? _____

When the page starts to fill up

One entry is a bad day. People forget things, skip meals and sleep badly, and always have. This sheet earns its keep on the entries that repeat, and on the ones still true when you re-read them a month on.

Compare it with normal, not with perfect. A change only means something against what your parent's days usually look like. If you haven't written that down, the normal-day sheet in this series is the place, and doing it makes this page twice as useful.

Clusters matter more than counts. Three entries about food in a month say more than five entries about five different things. When a theme shows up, that theme is the sentence to say out loud.

Take the dates to the doctor, not the worry. "Since March: two falls she didn't mention, the stove twice, weight down" is a history a doctor can act on. "I'm worried about my mother" is a feeling they can only nod at. This page, read aloud, is the first version.

Some entries mean today, not the doctor. Anything about the stove, smoke, driving, or medicine doubled up is not a watch-and-wait line. Treat those as things to fix this week, and write down what you changed.

Start a fresh page every few months. Date the old one and keep it. Two filled pages side by side answer the hardest question there is here, which is whether things are actually different or you are just frightened today.

Page started _____ Page ended _____